

UNITY OF LIFE I: LIFE OF THE CELL



College of the Environment,
Forestry, and Natural Sciences

Department of Biological Sciences

BIO 181: Unity of Life
Section 1 Fall 2024

GENERAL INFORMATION

Three (3) semester hours of credit.
This class meets three times per
week
Monday, Wednesday, and Friday
from 9:10 – 10:00 am
Building 88 (Wettaw) Room 130

Course prerequisites:
completion of a high-school class in
biology, algebra, and chemistry.

Mode of instruction: face-to-face.

INSTRUCTOR & COMMUNICATION

Silke Buschmann, Ph.D.

Contact: Please **use the Canvas
messaging system** (left-hand side
menu)

In all our communications, students,
teaching assistants (TAs),
supplemental instructors (SIs) and
instructor are expected to be
courteous and professional in their
email communications, as well as
state clearly the purpose of their
message. Please take a look at the
message template in Canvas.

Student hours:

Student hours are virtual. Use the
Zoom information below. Before you
can attend a student hour meeting
you need to establish a Zoom
account using your NAU email
address (not your private email
address).

Meeting ID: 837 4929 2992
Password: 181

VIRTUAL STUDENT HOURS

I offer two hours of virtual student
hours each week. Students are
encouraged to sign up for one of the
15 min. time slots to ask questions in
a one-on-one meeting.

Times are Mondays and
Wednesdays from 12:30 PM – 13:30
PM.

To attend, please sign up for one 15
min. time slot in Canvas by clicking
on the calendar in the global
navigation menu (the blue right-hand
side menu), find the 'Appointments'
button on the right side, select the
date you would like to attend, and
click 'Reserve'.

You may attend student hours as
many times as you wish throughout
the semester, but I ask that you
attend only one session per day to
give others a chance to sign up as
well.

If you cannot attend the above times
due to your class schedule, please
send me a message and we will find
a day and time that fits into our
schedules.

This syllabus contains important information that each student must be familiar with before starting the course. Please set aside about 30 min. of your time and read this document in its entirety!

Note: If your schedule changes and you must switch to another BIO 181 section on a different day and/or at a different time, please inform me before the switch. Once you switch courses, all your Canvas data is erased, and you need to redo all of your work.

COURSE PURPOSE

This is the first semester of a 2-semester introductory biology course for biology-related majors. Unity of Life I: Life of the Cell emphasizes molecular and cellular properties of life on earth by studying eight unifying principles. Topics include cell structure and function, basic metabolic processes common to all cells, and genetics as the basis for diversity. Students will build their own explanations in understanding fundamental biological processes by participating in discussions and teamwork. This course has received certification in NAU's First Year Learning Initiative.

STUDENT LEARNING OUTCOMES

Students will be able to:

- * compare and contrast general structures of prokaryotic and eukaryotic cells and their functions.
- * justify the relevance and context of eight different biological processes and their role in the life of an organism. The eight biological processes are membrane transport, mitosis, meiosis, DNA replication, transcription, translation, cellular respiration, and photosynthesis.
- * use biology-related terminology to describe the biological machinery involved in each process, and how it is used.
- * organize the sequence of events of the biological processes mentioned above.

CAREER READINESS

BIO 181 is designed to support and foster a foundation of student career readiness. This course will prepare you for success in the workplace and for lifelong career management through practicing the following competencies and transferable skills:

Career and Self Development

Apply assignment feedback and advice you receive during student hours to pursue continual growth, display curiosity for the subject, and advocate for yourself and others.

Critical

Gather and analyze information during teamwork and while answering iClicker questions and test questions to fully understand a problem and accurately summarize and interpret data.

Thinking

Teamwork

Participate in teamwork and listen to others without interrupting while collaborating to complete the work.

Professionalism

Demonstrate dependability by consistently submitting assignments before or by their due dates, with few errors, and being present and well prepared for each class meeting.

Technology

Quickly adapt to new or unfamiliar technologies and identify appropriate technology for completing specific tasks such as submitting assignments.

GENERAL COURSE STRUCTURE

The Arizona Board of Regents (ABOR) provides policy guidance to all of Arizona's universities. According to ABOR Policy 2-204 on Academic Credit, 1 credit hour requires a minimum of 45 hours of work. Of these, 15 hours are devoted to 'contact' hours (e.g. lecture) and the other 30 hours are filled with 'additional' work (homework, teamwork, etc.). BIO 181 is a 3-credit course that requires 135 hours of work over the semester (45 'contact' and 90 hours 'additional' work). 'Contact' hours are divided into in-person hours and hours spent completing out-of-class quizzes and the final exam. 'Additional' work includes weekly out-of-class assignments (reading, vocabulary quizzes, and concept map quizzes), individual studying time, attending SI sessions, and completing worksheets during class. These additional work hours are estimated to require at least 6 hours/week.

In BIO 181, part of the time you need for studying the course material is time you will spend outside of class time, but **some of the learning will occur during class**. Class time is divided between lecture and practice, which is a mix of 'contact' and 'additional' time. In order to provide you with class time for practice (completing teamwork, answering iClicker questions, and participating in discussions) I ask that you spend some of the out-of-class time to watch one or more short lecture videos before attending class. The **videos contain information** that I will **not** cover in class, but that I will build practice activities upon.

Watching the lecture videos before you come to class does not require extra time, they are part of the 'additional' out-of-class time you need for learning. In return you will receive class time that you spend on practice, also part of learning, as practice leads to understanding the course concepts.

BIO 181 covers 14 topics; each topic is taught over the course of approximately one week. New topics usually start on Monday depending on how fast we move through the material. Each topic is divided into a series of specific learning outcomes that will guide you through the concepts.

All class materials that you need access to are in your Canvas course page. You need to understand how to work within the Canvas framework and are expected to be able to navigate through Canvas by the end of the first week of classes.

Please bring pen and paper, or a notebook or a tablet and take handwritten notes while you are in class. We will cover new material every class session. We will practice and discuss many concepts in class, you will participate in teamwork, answer iClicker questions, and discuss all additional questions that you bring. Coming to and participating in class is the first step to student success, therefore, please make a point of attending.

To prepare for class, please navigate to your weekly module and find the video lectures (if present, not all modules contain videos) and the lecture notes handout that I provide for you. I recommend that you print the handout and use it to take notes on while you watch the video(s) and complete your weekly reading assignment.

BIO 181 COVID-19 SAFETY

The danger of contracting COVID-19 has not passed. Because our lecture hall is large and you will be sitting close to other students and unable to maintain physical distancing, I recommend that you wear a face mask fully covering your face from nose to chin while you are in the classroom. Please do not wear bandanas, neck gaiters, and masks

containing valves as these do not offer adequate protection.

If you are feeling unwell and/or experience any symptoms of COVID-19, please stay home, get tested, and follow guidance from medical professionals.

MISSING CLASS DUE TO ILLNESS

If you become ill and miss class, please notify me **ONLY** if you miss **more than two class meetings**. Please do not email me otherwise, you will not get a response.

If you miss more than two class meetings due to illness, find the 'Doctor's Note Submission Box' page in the 'Resources' module. Click on the page, then enter your information as instructed. If you need extensions on assignments, please send me a separate message within Canvas as I will not review the Doctor's note submissions until the end of the semester.

To obtain class notes, contact one of your classmates. I do not hand out lecture notes and because classes also contain teamwork and examples/explanations I talk through with the class, these are not in written form. It is always a good idea to come to student hours (please reserve a time slot) and ask me questions about the material you missed, and to attend SI sessions.

RESPECT FOR DIVERSITY

It is my intent that students from all diverse backgrounds and perspectives be well served by this course, and that the diversity and prior experiences that students bring to this class be viewed as a resource that strengthens our community.

I strive to do my best to present materials and activities that are respectful of diversity: gender, sexuality, disability, age, socioeconomic status, ethnicity (e.g. your language, heritage, and religion), and race (e.g. your skin color and hair color). Your suggestions to improve the effectiveness of the course in regards to equity, diversity and content are encouraged and appreciated.

If any of our class meetings conflict with your religious events, please contact me so we can make arrangements.

Your experience in this class is important to me. If you have already established accommodations with Disability Resources, I will have received a letter and will grant you testing accommodations. If you have classroom accommodations, please introduce yourself to me before class so we can discuss your needs in this course.

INSTITUTIONAL EXCUSES

Please upload all institutional excuses via the 'Institutional Excuse' submission box, located in the 'Resources' module in Canvas. Please do not email me your forms but submit them through Canvas.

BIO 181 COMMUNITY

The community in BIO 181 consists of the instructors, teaching assistants, supplemental instructors, and students. We are a community of learners, and our main goal is student success. No student is alone in their experience of taking this class. We are here to support each other in our journey through the functioning of the cell and the first majors biology course of your academic career. Let us participate and look after each other inside and outside of the classroom.

BIO 181 is based on the experience that *everyone has the capability to learn biology*. As part of the BIO 181 community, we can influence each other's lives and we aim at doing so in a positive way. With this in mind, the class has the following rules.

Treat our time with respect – Please come to class early, set aside any distractions, and be ready to learn.

Approach your classmates with kindness and encouragement – Our community is best supported by being the type of person you would like to turn to when you are in need of help.

Learning is a process – Keep this in mind when you allocate time for the class. We learn more in one hour each day on three separate days than in three hours in one day. The course provides lots of opportunities for practice that can help you with this.

WORKING THROUGH THE COURSE IN CANVAS

The course is set up in **14 week-long biology modules** and **1 module in introductory chemistry**.

Each **biology module** starts with an overview page, leads through all required assignments, and ends with a summary page. You will work on each module for several hours each week over multiple days. Do not try to complete a module in one long sitting, you will not learn much by rushing through. Please access the module materials by clicking on 'Modules' in the Canvas left-hand side menu. Do not click on an assignment in the calendar; if you use the calendar to access assignments you will miss additional materials, for example the handouts and video lectures, and thereby miss points.

Each biology module opens 2 weeks before we cover it in class. It is not advised that students work more than one week ahead as we cover a lot of material and each week requires your full attention.

The **module in introductory chemistry** contains 6 mini-modules which are to be completed within the first three weeks of classes. Each mini-module should take 45 min. to an hour to be completed. The study of biology relies on basic chemistry principles that we will not cover extensively in class, therefore, we make them part of the first quarter of the semester.

Unlike the full biology modules, the mini chemistry modules do not open one at a time, they are already accessible to you once the course begins.

I strongly advise that you complete them as soon as possible as you move through your first few weeks. For due dates see the class calendar.

GRADING/EVALUATION OF STUDENT PROGRESS

You will complete four assignments each week: reading, vocabulary, concept, and a worksheet. Read below for information on these and on all other course assessments and assignments.

Participation (33 points – 33 class meetings at 1 point per day - 5% of final grade)

We will meet 38 times in-class this semester. Class attendance is one of the most important things you can do to be successful in class. You will receive 1 point per day for up to 33 days of attendance. This provides you with 5 days of no-penalty absences due to sickness, personal situations, etc. Use them cautiously. Each day we will cover new material and practice previous concepts.

Attendance will be recorded through class using the 'iClicker Student' app. A subscription to this application is paid for by NAU. Please download the iClicker Student app onto your phone, create an account, and add our course. Make sure to select the correct section number. You also find a direct link to the sign-up page in the BIO 181 Canvas 'Welcome' module.

Note: when you sign up, please use the same name in iClicker that you used when you registered at NAU. If your iClicker name does not match the name on the BIO 181 class roster you will not receive points.

While class attendance is required per the above stated policy, please be cautious about attending class if you are feeling ill. If you are experiencing flu-like symptoms, you should not attend class; please take precautions not to infect others and seek medical attention.

If you have to miss class multiple days in a row because you are sick (COVID-19 related or not) please contact me within 3 days or as soon as possible. Together, we will work to develop a schedule up for you to make up any missing work. As your instructor, I can only help if you communicate with me.

First Week Assignments (6 points - 1% of final grade)

During the first five days of the first week, you need to complete two special assignments that only happen in week 1. They are found in the "Welcome" module. These are the 'Update Canvas Notification and Photo' assignment and the 'Syllabus Quiz'. For due dates see the class calendar.

Pre- and Post-tests (16 points - 2.5% of final grade)

A pre-test will provide me with valuable information regarding your current knowledge level so the course can be adjusted to meet your needs. To gather an independent evaluation of how much you learned during the semester a post-test will become available for you to take at the end of the term. For due dates see the class calendar.

On each test, read each question and all the answer choices carefully. **You are not expected to know the answers to all of the questions.** Think about what the question is asking and choose the best answer. The test results will NOT impact your grade for the course, but you must complete the test to earn the points. Please take your time and put forth a good effort. No points will be awarded to students completing either test in less than 15 minutes. Neither test will be re-opened. Each test is worth 8 points. If you increase the grade of the post-test (compared to the pre-test) by 7 answers (15%), or score >80% on each test, an extra 8 points will be awarded.

Chemistry Tests (12 points - 2% of final grade)

The mini-module in introductory chemistry is to be completed during the first three weeks of classes with 2 of the six topics tested each week. See class calendar for due dates.

Reading Assignments (65 points – 5 points each week - 10% of final grade)

Each week you will complete a reading assignment that introduces the material of the week. You can access these and all other weekly assignments in Canvas through the 'Modules' in the left-hand side menu. These pre-lecture reading assignments are taken through "LearnSmart" which is the platform provided by the textbook publisher McGraw Hill. You will have access to the platform when you purchase the book and sign up for LearnSmart (for more details see below: Materials).

How to purchase the book and access the reading assignments:

For a short video on how to access your textbook, click on the 'Reading: McGraw-Hill Connect' link in the 'Welcome' module in Canvas.

- * Go to Module 1 in Canvas
- * Click on '1-Reading Assignment – Cells' on the Cells Overview page
- * Click on 'Launch Assignment'
- * Establish a Connect account using your NAU email address. **Note:** when you sign up, please use the same name that you used when you registered at NAU. If your Connect name does not match the name on the BIO 181 class roster you will not receive points.
- * Now you register. You can use the 20-day free trial or purchase the book now. If you need help purchasing the book, please find the link in the online Canvas syllabus.
- * You can navigate to your first reading assignment. If that is not intuitive, close the Connect website,

go back to Canvas and click on the 1-Reading Assignment link again.

* Log in and you should be directed to your assignment. Click on 'Start Reading'.

* Read, take notes, and answer the pop-up questions until you are done.

* If you are experiencing difficulties, please call the McGraw Hill Help Desk at 1-800-331-5094

The reading assignments are designed to evaluate student understanding of the concepts. You will read the ebook chapter(s) assigned for the week and answer practice questions. Before you start you are given an estimated time until finish, and the number for concepts covered. You switch to the next concept by using the arrows on the left.

Note that your textbook contains more material than is assigned to your weekly reading. LearnSmart will show you highlighted sections that contain the concepts we cover each week. You should read through the non-highlighted text as well as it increases your understanding of the context. Focus your attention and note-taking to the highlighted sections.

Please make sure to take the reading assignments seriously: provide yourself with at least one hour of undisturbed time and take notes on important concepts while you read.

If you try to rush it will result in the assignments taking longer because the LearnSmart software adds more questions if the initial ones were answered incorrectly!

Points are awarded based on completion. Each student will have access to reports that show which items were missed or answered correctly and whether you thought you knew/were unsure/did not know an answer. Use these reports to

inform yourself about which concepts you need to review.

The reading assignments are due every Tuesday night at 11:59pm, except for week 1. The lowest reading assignment score will be dropped from the final grade calculations.

Please note that the free trial is valid for 20 days ONLY and you will lose access immediately after the trial expires. You must purchase the book in order to receive credit for your homework reading assignments and to access the tests. For help purchasing textbooks, please find the link in the online Canvas syllabus.

Vocabulary Mastery Quizzes (52 points – 4 points each week - 8.5% of final grade)

After completion of the reading assignment(s) for each topic, students are expected to master the new vocabulary. You are encouraged to make a vocabulary list and review the terms. To prove that mastery of the vocabulary has been achieved students will complete a weekly Vocabulary Mastery Quiz. These quizzes are due on Thursdays at 11:59pm, except for week 1. Each quiz is worth 4 points. You will have 2 attempts to earn these points. The Vocabulary Mastery Quiz with the lowest score will be dropped from the final grade calculations.

Teamwork and Worksheet Quizzes (65 points – 5 points each week - 10% of final grade)

Each week we will have at least one worksheet that will be completed in small groups during class time. You will be applying the concepts learned in a diversity of activities throughout the semester. All members of the group will work as a team but you each submit your answers individually by completing the Worksheet Quizzes which contain the exact same questions as the worksheets themselves. Because you complete the worksheets in class you only have one attempt for the quiz which is due each Friday at 11:59pm, except for week 1. The purpose of these worksheets is for students to practice and to get feedback on their work. Please make a point in retrieving the graded worksheets and reviewing them. The Worksheet Quiz with the lowest score will be dropped from the final grade calculations.

Concept Map Quizzes (65 points – 5 points per week - 10% of final grade)

Connecting concepts and ideas is key to learning the material and succeeding in BIO 181. To achieve this, students will complete a concept map in preparation to take the weekly Concept Map Quiz, due Fridays at 11:59 pm, except for week 1. We will take a look at the concept maps in class before you submit your quiz. Each quiz is worth 5 points and you will have 2 attempts to earn these points. The Concept Map Quiz with the lowest score will be dropped from the final grade calculations.

Tests (240 points - 38% of final grade)

Six tests will be given throughout the semester. The tests will cover the material from the previous two or three weeks. The last test only covers the last topic. Each test will contain at least one question per learning outcome. Question types are an assortment of types: matching, multiple choice, true/false, fill in the blank, algebraic calculations, and others.

Academic Integrity: Tests are closed book with no external aide/help of any sort permitted. You will complete the tests on the Connect website. During test time, your browser is locked: you will need to stay on the test site the entire time you work on the test. Attempting to open another tab in your browser will immediately close your test and result in a grade of zero.

All test dates and times are in the Canvas class calendar. The due dates are also listed here:

Practice test (1 point) Sept. 12
Test 1 Topics 1-3 (60 pts) Sept. 16
Test 2 Topics 4-6 (60 pts) Oct. 7
Test 3 Topics 7-8 (40 pts) Oct. 21
Test 4 Topics 9-10 (40 pts) Nov. 4
Test 5 Topics 11-13 (60 pts) Nov. 25
Test 6 Topic 14 (20 pts) Dec. 5

Of the 280 possible points, 40 points will be dropped from the calculations from the final grade.

If a student scores 85% or higher average on **ALL** six tests, they will be exempt of taking the final exam.

Final exam (80 points - 13% of final grade)

The final comprehensive exam will be given during finals week and is worth 80 points. You will have 2 hours to complete the exam. No make-up exams will be available. The final examination cannot be dropped.

Extra Credit (up to 11.5 points - 2%)

I offer three options of earning extra credit points.

1. You can complete the practice test (1 point)
2. You can complete the optional chemistry reading assignment by its due date (2.5 points)
3. You can do well on the post-test and improve your score by 7 or more correct answers (compared to pre-test) (8 points)

No other opportunities for extra credit exist - please do not ask!

GRADING SYSTEM

The overall course percentile grades will be converted to a letter grade using the following scale:

- 90-100% = A
- 80-89% = B
- 70-79% = C
- 60-69% = D
- 60-50% = F

All grades will be posted in Canvas. They continuously update and can be accessed through 'Grades' in the left-hand side menu.

As you can see above, the grading scale in this class uses a 50% minimum scale. Grades will not fall below 50% to give each student a chance to increase their current grade by 10% to get to the next higher grade level. This does not mean that you cannot fail an assignment or fail the course – 50% is not a passing grade. But every student has an equal chance of increasing their grade to the next higher grade level regardless of their current grade.

Note: to receive at least 50% on the tests you need to take the test and put forth a good effort. If you do not complete the test, answer less than 60% of the questions, or violate the academic integrity policy, your test grade will be zero.

Student progress is assessed based on the Pre- and Post-Tests, Reading Assignments, Chemistry Modules, Vocabulary Mastery Quizzes, Concept Map Quizzes, Worksheet Quizzes, Participation, Tests, and a comprehensive Final Exam.

Point breakdown of all course assignments

Participation **33** pts.
1st week assignments **6** pts.
Pre- and post-tests **16** pts.
Chemistry **12** pts.
Reading **65** pts, due Tuesdays
Vocab quizzes **52** pts, due Thursd.
Worksheet quizzes **65** pts, due Frid.
Concept maps **65** pts, due Fridays
Tests **240** pts.
Final exam **80** pts.
Total: **634** points

REQUIRED MATERIALS:

Ebook and LearnSmart: Principles of Biology, by Brooker et al., 4th edition. You can sign up for the ebook beginning on the first day of class through Canvas (see 'Welcome' module). As soon as you sign up and pay the book fee you are granted access to LearnSmart and the ebook for 1 semester. You may also get a physical copy of the book at the NAU bookstore for an additional cost. However, a physical copy of the book will **not** give you access to the digital homework and tests.

Note: if you bought book access during a previous semester, you need to re-purchase the book in order to have continued access throughout the semester.

CLASS OUTLINE

You find the class due dates in the Canvas calendar.

CLASS POLICIES

Late work policy

Students are expected to turn in their work on time. However, if the case arises that you are late turning in an assignment you will have up to 5 days to be late on some assignments and still receive up to 90% of the original grade. Late **vocabulary quizzes, concept map quizzes, and worksheet quizzes** will be graded with a reduction in grade of **2% per day over five days** (day 1: 2% off, day 2: 4% off, etc.). **Reading assignments** will be graded with a **10% reduction in grade regardless** of when the reading was submitted late within the 5 day period.

Note that all assignments will close after five days - you can only submit up to 5 days late.

Please note that chemistry mini-modules, tests and the final exam are NOT part of the late work policy!

If you missed a test due to illness or other emergency circumstances, you need to contact your instructor before you miss the test.

Computer/device policy

Access to a computer/tablet and internet service is indispensable to completing homework, tests, and other course assessments in Canvas and Connect. Please do **not** bring a computer to class unless you have a qualifying accommodation through Disability Resources. You may take handwritten notes on a tablet using an electric pen. Smartphones or tablets will be used to record attendance through in-class participation.

Students are **not allowed** to use their devices during class time for any other purposes than participating in the class.

My requests are that you:

* set your devices to silent during class time

*** do not intentionally use your device for anything other than participation in class content**

* step out of the classroom if you plan or expect to use a device for other purposes

Please note that I will ask you to leave the class for the day if you use your phone outside of answering iClicker questions.

NAU's SYLLABUS POLICY STATEMENTS

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

NAU expects every student to firmly adhere to a strong ethical code of academic integrity in all their scholarly pursuits. The primary attributes of academic integrity are honesty, trustworthiness, fairness, and responsibility. As a student, you are expected to submit original work while giving proper credit to other people's ideas or contributions. Acting with academic integrity means completing your assignments independently while truthfully acknowledging all sources of information, or collaboration with others when appropriate. When you submit your work, you are implicitly declaring that the work is your own. Academic integrity is expected not only during formal coursework, but in all your relationships or interactions that are connected to the educational enterprise. All forms of academic deceit such as plagiarism, cheating, collusion, falsification or fabrication of results or records, permitting your work to be submitted by another, or inappropriately recycling your own work from one class to another, constitute academic misconduct that may result in serious disciplinary consequences. All students and faculty members are responsible for reporting suspected instances of academic misconduct. All students are encouraged to complete NAU's online academic integrity workshop available in the E-Learning Center and should review the full Academic Integrity policy available at <https://www9.nau.edu/policies/Client/Details/1443?wholsLooking=Students&pertainsTo=All>

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Artificial intelligence (AI) technologies bring both opportunities and challenges. Ensuring honesty in academic work creates a culture of integrity and expectations of ethical behavior. The use of these technologies can depend on the instructional setting, varying by faculty member, program, course, and assignment. Please refer to course policies, any additional course-specific guidelines in the syllabus, or communicate with the instructor to understand expectations. NAU recognizes the role that these technologies will play in the current and future careers of our graduates and expects students to practice responsible and ethical use of AI technologies to assist with learning within the confines of course policies.

COPYRIGHT INFRINGEMENT

All lectures and course materials, including but not limited to exams, quizzes, study outlines, and similar materials are protected by copyright. These materials may not be shared, uploaded, distributed, reproduced, or publicly displayed without the express written permission of NAU. Sharing materials on websites such as Course Hero, Chegg, or related websites is considered copyright infringement subject to United States Copyright Law and a violation of NAU Student Code of Conduct. For additional information on ABOR policies relating to course materials, please refer to ABOR Policy 6-908 A(2)(5).

COURSE TIME COMMITMENT

Pursuant to Arizona Board of Regents guidance (ABOR Policy 2-224, Academic Credit), each unit of credit requires a minimum of 45 hours of work by students, including but not limited to, class time, preparation, homework, and studying. For example, for a 3-credit course a student should expect to work at least 8.5 hours each week in a 16-week session and a minimum of 33 hours per week for a 3-credit course in a 4-week session.

DISRUPTIVE BEHAVIOR

Membership in NAU's academic community entails a special obligation to maintain class environments that are conducive to learning, whether instruction is taking place in the classroom, a laboratory or clinical setting, during course-related fieldwork, or online. Students have the obligation to engage in the educational process in a manner that does not interfere with normal class activities or violate the rights of others. Instructors have the authority and responsibility to address disruptive behavior that interferes with student learning, which can include the involuntary withdrawal of a student from a course with a grade of "W". For additional information, see NAU's Disruptive Behavior in an Instructional Setting policy at <https://nau.edu/university-policy-library/disruptive-behavior>.

NONDISCRIMINATION AND ANTI-HARASSMENT

NAU prohibits discrimination and harassment based on sex, gender, gender identity, race, color, age, national origin, religion, sexual orientation, disability, veteran status and genetic information. Certain consensual amorous or sexual relationships between faculty and students are also prohibited as set forth in the Consensual Romantic and Sexual Relationships policy. The Equity and Access Office (EAO)

responds to complaints regarding discrimination and harassment that fall under NAU's Nondiscrimination and Anti-Harassment policy. To report a concern related to possible unlawful discrimination or harassment or to request a time to meet, please use the Report an Issue Form. To file a complaint, please submit the online Complaint Form. EAO also assists with religious accommodations. To request a religious accommodation, please use the Religious Accommodation Request Intake Form. EAO additionally provides access to lactation spaces, and please use the Lactation Space Request Form to request use of a location. For additional information about nondiscrimination or anti-harassment, contact EAO at EquityandAccess@nau.edu, or visit the EAO website at <https://nau.edu/equity-and-access>. The EAO is located in Old Main on the first floor.

TITLE IX

Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, as amended, protects individuals from discrimination based on sex in any educational program or activity operated by recipients of federal financial assistance. In accordance with Title IX, Northern Arizona University prohibits discrimination based on sex or gender in all its programs or activities. Sex discrimination includes sexual harassment, sexual assault, relationship violence, and stalking. NAU does not discriminate on the basis of sex in the education programs or activities that it operates, including in admission and employment. NAU is committed to providing an environment free from discrimination based on sex or gender and provides a number of supportive measures that assist students, faculty and staff employees, and covered guests.

One may direct inquiries concerning the application of Title IX to either or both the university Title IX Coordinator or the U.S. Department of Education, Assistant Secretary, Office of Civil Rights. You may contact NAU's Title IX Coordinator at titleix@nau.edu or by phone at 928-523-5434. In furtherance of its Title IX obligations, NAU promptly will investigate or equitably resolve all reports of sex/gender-based discrimination, harassment, or sexual misconduct and will eliminate any hostile environment as defined by law. To submit a report, please use the File a Report Form. The Office for the Resolution of Sexual Misconduct (ORSM): Title IX Institutional Compliance, Prevention & Response addresses matters that fall under the university's Sexual Misconduct Policy. ORSM also facilitates reasonable modifications for pregnant or parenting individuals. Additional important information and related resources, including how to request help or confidential support following conduct covered by the Sexual Misconduct Policy, is available on the ORSM web site, and you also may contact the office at titleix@nau.edu. The ORSM is located in Gammage on the third floor.

ACCESSIBILITY

Professional disability specialists are available at Disability Resources to facilitate a range of academic support services and accommodations for students with disabilities. If you have a documented disability, you can request assistance by contacting Disability Resources at 928-523-8773 (voice), 928-523-8747 (fax), or dr@nau.edu (e-mail). Once eligibility has been determined, students register with Disability Resources every semester to activate their approved accommodations. Although a student may request an accommodation at any time, it is best to initiate the application process at least four weeks before a student wishes to receive an accommodation. Students may begin the accommodation process by submitting a self-identification form online at <https://nau.edu/disability-resources/student-eligibility-process> or by contacting Disability Resources. The Director of Disability Resources, Jamie Axelrod, serves as NAU's Americans with Disabilities Act Coordinator and Section 504 Compliance Officer. He can be reached at jamie.axelrod@nau.edu.

RESPONSIBLE CONDUCT OF RESEARCH

Students who engage in research at NAU must receive appropriate Responsible Conduct of Research (RCR) training. This instruction is designed to help ensure proper awareness and application of well-established professional norms and ethical principles related to the performance of all scientific research activities. More information regarding RCR training is available at <https://nau.edu/research/compliance/research-integrity>.

MISCONDUCT IN RESEARCH

As noted, NAU expects every student to firmly adhere to a strong code of academic integrity in all their scholarly pursuits. This includes avoiding fabrication, falsification, or plagiarism when conducting research or reporting research results. Engaging in research misconduct may result in serious disciplinary consequences. Students must also report any suspected or actual instances of research misconduct of which they become aware. Allegations of research misconduct should be reported to your instructor or the University's Research Integrity Officer, Scott Pryor, who can be reached at scott.pryor@nau.edu or 928-523-5927. More information about misconduct in research is available at <https://nau.edu/university-policy-library/misconduct-in-research>.

SENSITIVE COURSE MATERIALS

University education aims to expand student understanding and awareness. Thus, it necessarily involves engagement with a wide range of information, ideas, and creative representations. In their college studies, students can expect to encounter and to critically appraise materials that may differ from and perhaps challenge familiar understandings, ideas, and beliefs. Students are encouraged to discuss these matters with faculty.

Last revised August 5, 2024